

Product Manager End-of-Life Plan - Mobile WB-3000

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Scenario summary

Item	Summary
Product overview	Product: Mobile Laptop Interface Whiteboard (Mobile WB-3000). Company: Let's Work Together (LWT) LLC. The product is a lightweight laptop-connected whiteboard and laptop stand for note capture, brainstorming, screen sharing, annotation, and real-time collaboration.
EOL objective	Execute a planned retirement after the two-year market window while protecting customers, partners, contracts, warranties, and the replacement model launch.

EOL plan template completion

EOL planning category	End-of-life plan entry
Product identification	- Product line: Mobile Laptop Interface Whiteboard. Product ID/SKU: Mobile WB-3000. - Product mix impact: retiring WB-3000 after the planned lifecycle creates room for an updated model while preserving LWT participation in portable whiteboard products.
Rationale	- LWT planned a two-year product lifecycle because collaboration technology will advance and a refreshed model is expected to be more competitive. - Marketing estimates costs will exceed benefits to maintain the product at the end of three years. - The goal is planned replacement, not abrupt abandonment.
Retirement strategy	- Use a spin-off/replacement strategy: leverage current features and technology to create an updated version. - Harvest remaining demand during the final six months, then transition customers to the replacement model. - Honor all contracts and warranties to reduce dissatisfaction and legal risk.
Proposed mitigation plan	- Map transition from active sale to replacement communications, final ordering, warranty support, parts support, upgrade incentives, and retirement closure. - Create an issue management hotline and track all transition concerns. - Offer incentives so current customers can acquire the updated model easily.
Communications planning	- Notify all customers six months before replacement date. - Coordinate internal briefings for Sales, Customer Support, Manufacturing, Operations, Legal, and distributor partners. - External messaging should explain replacement benefits, support continuity, warranty commitments, and transition deadlines.
Internal impact	- Manufacturing and Operations: manage final production, parts inventory, manuals, upgrades, and production cutoff. - Customer Support: maintain help desk, FAQ, complaints, returns, troubleshooting, and warranty support through the transition period. - Sales/Marketing: update collateral, stop outdated promotions, train channel partners, and prepare replacement product sales tools. - Legal/HR: validate contracts, warranty obligations, compliance, staffing needs, and customer notification language.
External impact	- Customers receive transition dates, replacement incentives, support channels, warranty coverage, and final order windows. - Walmart, Amazon, and other distributors receive listing update dates, inventory sell-through guidance, and replacement launch materials. - Education, business, and government buyers receive continuity messaging to prevent surprise and dissatisfaction.
Cost analysis	- Compare support, inventory, warranty, channel, and communications costs against expected remaining revenue. - Approval required from Product Sponsor, Finance, Legal, Operations, Sales, Marketing, and senior management. - Monitor upgrade incentive costs against retention and replacement-model revenue.
Scheduling	- Launch: July 20XX. Replacement communications: launch plus 18 months. Product transition and retirement: launch plus 24 months. - Final support and warranty activities continue according to contract terms. - Use monthly EOL readiness reviews starting at launch plus 15 months.

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Risk analysis	- Risks: customer dissatisfaction, surprise retirement, channel confusion, excess inventory, shortage of replacement units, warranty exposure, and competitor displacement. - Mitigations: early communication, incentives, hotline, contract review, inventory planning, clear distributor instructions, and executive approval gates.
Critical success factors (CSF)	- No unsupported warranty obligations; customer transition communications sent on time; upgrade incentive adoption meets target; unresolved EOL issues remain low; customer satisfaction remains above 95%; no major channel or legal escalations.